

Jonathan Alistair Jayes

Data Scientist • Economic Consultant

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Analytical and quantitatively-driven economist, completing a PhD, with 4 years of experience applying rigorous statistical analysis to complex market issues. Known for a proven ability to analyze market dynamics and competition policy, demonstrated through direct involvement in merger analysis and international trade disputes. Seeking to leverage advanced skills in econometrics, data visualization, and predictive modeling to deliver impactful insights on competition economics matters at Econic Partners.

Work Experience

Codera Analytics

Lund, Sweden

Data Scientist

2022 - Present

Led various data science projects, including managing clients and overseeing a team of three

- Led the development and successful testing of an AI-powered end-to-end solution in ML to automate data extraction from diverse corporate reports, reducing manual processing time by ~80%
- Managed the complete lifecycle of a large-scale public finance data project for Africa, from successful bid to delivery of a structured dataset covering 2,700+ documents
- Developed and implemented an SDMX-compliant ingestion pipeline for South African Reserve Bank (SARB) and National Treasury financial statistics, utilising Python for ETL processes and SQL for rigorous data validation, ultimately making key verified datasets publicly available on the Codera Analytics platform.

Fathom Data

Lund, Sweden

Junior Data Scientist

Summer 2022

Developed a data product analyzing scraped consumer pricing trends

- Developed an automated reporting pipeline using SQL and R to analyze consumer pricing trends from scraped web data, generating insights that informed commercial strategy and identification of potential client segments for marketing outreach

FTI Consulting

Stellenbosch, South Africa

Junior Competition Economics Consultant

2019 - 2020

Supported senior economists on competition cases, trade disputes, and industry assessments while developing my analytical skills:

- Drafted sections and compiled supporting evidence (incl. data visualizations) for the economic report on a 2-to-1 ostrich merger, contributing to analyses of market definition and competitive effects.
- Executed detailed analysis of South African poultry imports using 8-digit HS code data in Stata/Excel, identifying key trends in volume and pricing relevant to a trade dispute

Education

PhD in Economic History

Lund University

Planning to defend my thesis in October 2025.

2021 - 2025

- Designed and implemented a novel AI pipeline automating the extraction and structuring of data from historical biographical dictionaries, reducing manual transcription time by 3 months
- Applied Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques for analyzing biographical dictionary data to study skilled labor origins and career trajectories.

Masters in Economics

Stellenbosch University

Graduated with distinction.

2020 - 2021

Honours in Economics and Bachelors in Social Science

University of Cape Town

Dean's Merit List. Top mark in my year for four courses.

2015 - 2018

Skills

Technical Skills

- Data Analysis and Econometrics: Python (Pandas, Polars, scikit-learn), R (tidyverse, tidymodels), Advanced Excel, SQL, Stata
- Machine Learning & AI: Statistical Analysis, Predictive Modeling, NLP, LLM APIs (OpenAI, Gemini, Claude), scikit-learn
- Cloud & Automation: AWS (Lambda), Google Cloud (Functions), Git, GitHub Actions (CI/CD)
- Currently improving: Docker for containerization, and TypeScript for web development

Languages

English (native), Swedish (B2), French (A2).

Interests

Running, Geoguessr, and international trade.